FREE CHECKLIST · EU FUNDING & INNOVATION

Is your idea a fit for EU funding?

Good proposals often fail because they target the wrong programme. Use these six questions to test your idea before you invest time in writing.

Tick each box you can answer with confidence. Gaps are not a problem: they show you what to clarify first.

01 · MATURITY

How mature is it?

- [ ] I know roughly where the solution sits on the Technology Readiness Level (TRL) scale.
- [ ] I know whether I need research, a pilot or a demonstration next.

Research calls suit earlier stages. Innovation and demonstration calls expect solutions closer to market.

02 · INVESTMENT

How big is the investment?

- [ ] I have a first estimate of the total project budget.
- [ ] I know which costs (staff, equipment, pilots) funding should cover.

Programmes differ widely in project size, from small cascade grants to large-scale demonstrators.

03 · PARTNERS

Who needs to be on board?

- [ ] I know whether I can apply alone or need a consortium.
- [ ] I can name the partner types I'd need (industry, research, public bodies, end users).

Many collaborative calls require partners from several EU countries.

04 · CO-FUNDING

What can you co-fund?

- [ ] I know how much of the budget my organisation can contribute.
- [ ] I can cover cash flow between payments and reports.

Funding rates vary by programme and organisation type, so your own share matters.

05 · EU PRIORITIES

Does it fit EU priorities?

- [ ] I can link the idea to an EU goal such as the green transition, digitalisation or industrial leadership.
- [ ] I can describe its impact beyond my own organisation.

Evaluators score how well a project serves the policy goals behind the call.

06 · TIMING & RULES

When, and under which rules?

- [ ] I know when I need the money and how long the project would run.
- [ ] I'm aware of rules that apply, such as state aid, IP or data requirements.

Calls open on fixed cycles, so a good fit can still mean waiting for the right window.

10–12 ticks

You're ready to shortlist programmes and plan a proposal.

5–9 ticks

A solid start. Close the gaps before choosing a call.

0–4 ticks

Shape the concept first. A short conversation can save months.

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